

## How to Use Wazuh for Security Configuration Assessment (SCA)

### 1- Definition

Security Configuration Assessment (SCA) is a tool that checks your computer's settings to make sure it is secure, checks if your system configuration is hardened or if there are misconfigurations

While vulnerability detection



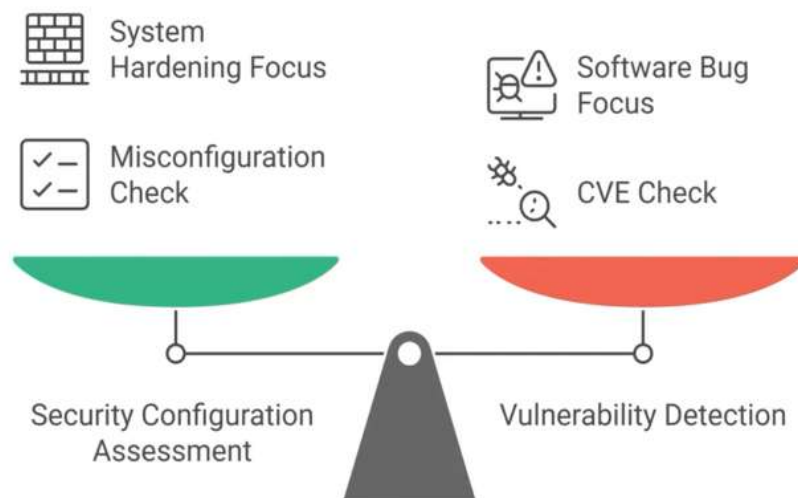
helps us identify host-aware vulnerabilities like CVEs, CIS benchmarks, packages, and daemons (looks for outdated software and bugs), SCA checks things like:

- Are your password rules strict enough?
- Is guest access disabled?
- Are administrative permissions locked down properly?

It compares your system against recommended security standards (like CIS benchmarks) and tells you what needs to be fixed.

**NB:** The VD wazuh manager fetches data from the vulnerability plugin's database and shows us scans against the agent hosts.

### SCA vs VD



## Configuring the Wazuh Server to integrate security configuration assessment (SCA)

1. **Open Configuration file:** Navigate to `/var/ossec/etc` and open the `ossec.conf` file.

**Add this Module Blocks** (Debian-based OS, Windows, and Linux environments):

```
<!-- For Ubuntu / Debian OS -->
<provider name="canonical">
<enabled>yes</enabled>
<os>trusty</os>
<os>xenial</os>
<os>bionic</os>
<os>focal</os>
<os>jammy</os>
<update_interval>1h</update_interval>
</provider>

<!-- For Windows Agents / OS -->
<provider name="msu">
<enabled>yes</enabled>
<update_interval>1h</update_interval>
</provider>

<!-- For RedHat / CentOS / AlmaLinux -->
<provider name="redhat">
<enabled>yes</enabled>
<update_interval>1h</update_interval>
</provider>
```

**NB:** make it will be between this:

```
<vulnerability-detection>
<enabled>yes</enabled>
<index-status>yes</index-status>
<feed-update-interval>60m</feed-update-interval>
HERE
</vulnerability-detection>
```

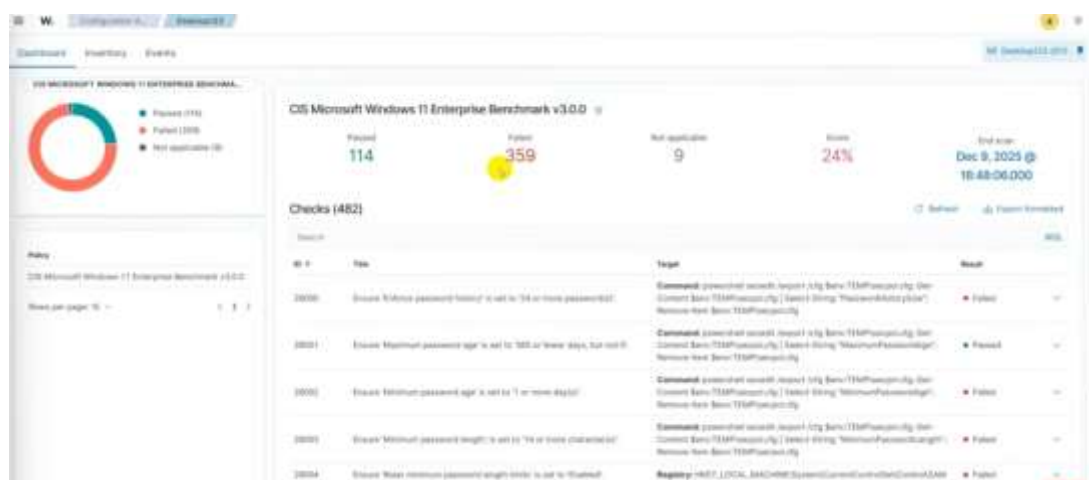
2. **Verify SCA:** Ensure that the SCA module is set to enabled (it is set to yes by default).
3. **Restart Services:** Save the file and restart the Wazuh server (`systemctl restart wazuh-manager`) to apply the changes.

## Reviewing SCA Results on the Dashboard

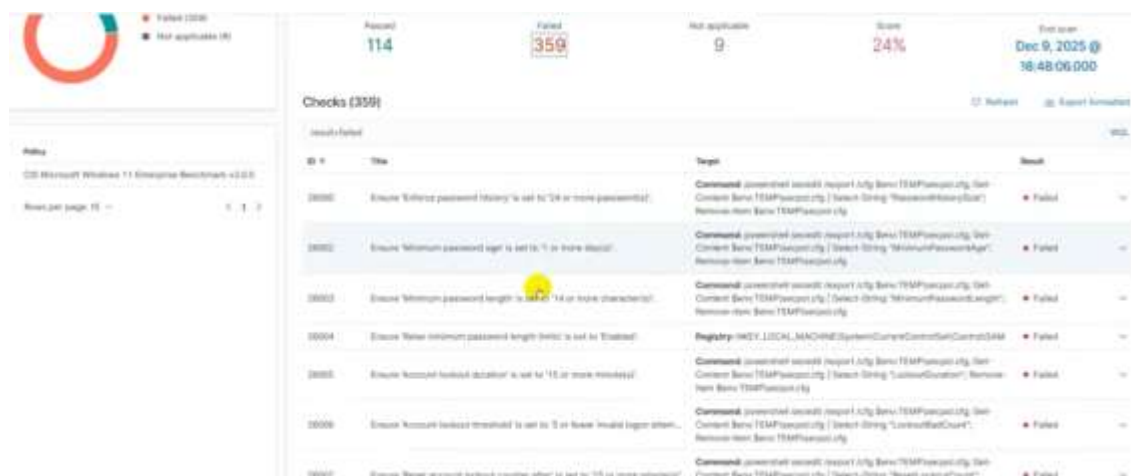
1. Navigate to the Wazuh dashboard and click on **Configuration Assessment**.
2. Select the target Windows agent to review its overall compliance score.

We can see which compliance or benchmarks it is fulfilling.

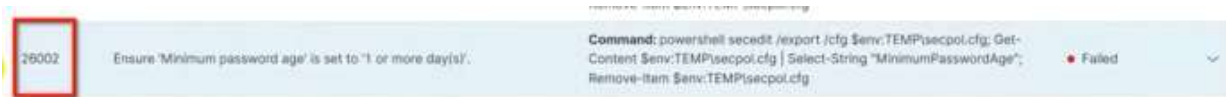
The score for our Windows machine is 24%, which means some security policies have been checked on our system to ensure whether our system is secure or not. Most of the settings have failed. This means our system is not meeting the recommended security standards. The details of all those recommendation checks, and security standards are shown here.



3. Click on **Failed**: It will show us the list of all failed standards or benchmarks.



**Example:** If we take ID 2602,



which means “Ensure minimum password age’ is set to ‘1 or more day(s)’.

**Explanation:** The user should use a new password for at least 1 day.

**Question:** Why is this set?

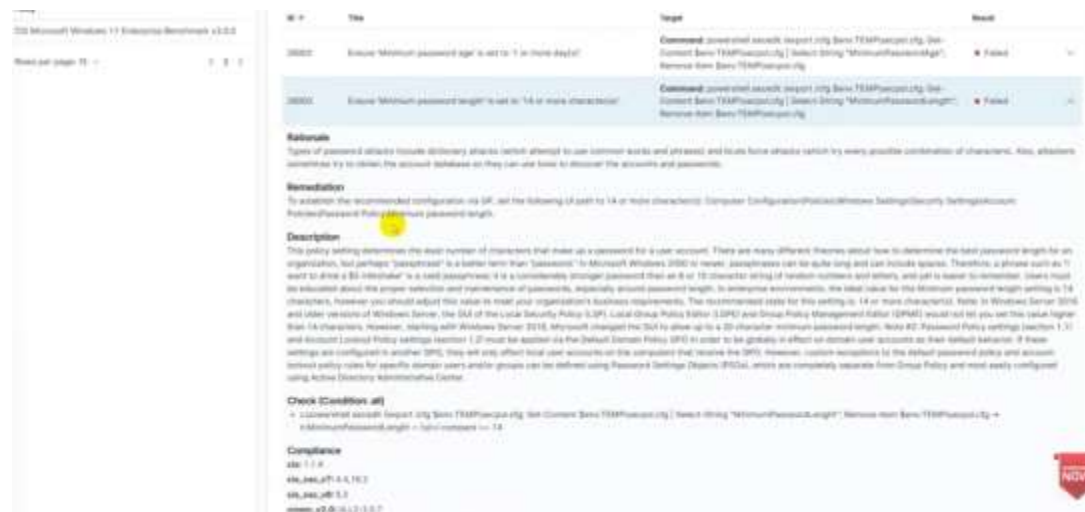
**Answer:** Because the user should be able to bypass the history list by frequently changing passwords and setting back their old favorite password.

Example: If we take 2603,



which means minimum password length, it has also failed. That means the minimum password length should be 14 characters. So, why is that? Because small passwords are easy to guess or crack through software.

By clicking on it, we can see this and can read its description or details, and the remediation or how to also provide. If we disagree with the decision, we can check it.



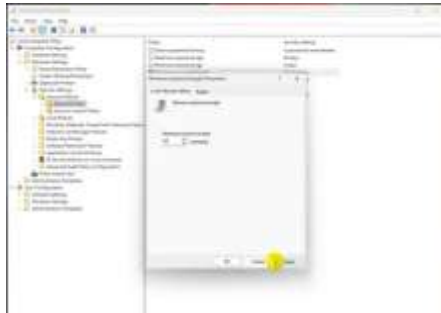
How to do: go to this path:

**Remediation**  
To establish the recommended configuration via GP, set the following UI path to 14 or more character(s): **Computer Configuration\Policies\Windows Settings\Security Settings\Account Policies\Password Policy\Minimum password length.**

We can check this setting.

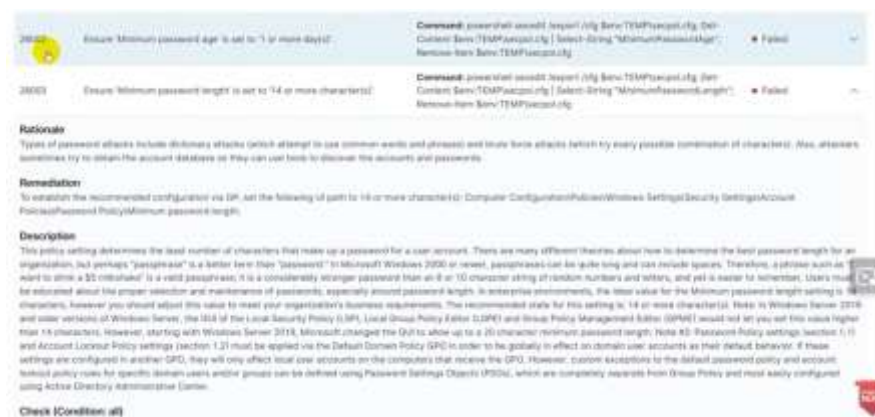
Do: go to our Windows machine or Windows→click on Start and type gpedit (or Local Group Policy Editor)→click on Computer Configuration→Windows Settings → Security Settings →Account Policies→Password Policy.

here we have Minimum password length. Currently, it is 0. If we set it to 14 here, we will pass this benchmark.



This is how we can pass or remediate this benchmark.

Now let's move to 26002.



We can read its description, and you can also fix it via PowerShell. Just copy this command:

```
Check (Condition: all)
• c:\powershell secedit /export /c/gp $env:TEMP\secpol.cfg; Get-Content $env:TEMP\secpol.cfg | Select-String "MinimumPasswordAge"; Remove-Item $env:TEMP\secpol.cfg -> n.MinimumPasswordAge < (id+).compare >= 1
```

We will go to our Windows agent again and run PowerShell as administrator, right-click, and the command will be entered.:



After that, if we hit Enter, we can pass this remediation or this benchmark.